

- Leave enough space in front of your vehicle to see what's happening on the road ahead.
- Check behind you after spotting a hazard that requires you to make a change. What's happening behind you can affect your decision-making

It's impossible to remove risk completely. However, you can learn how to avoid or minimize risks by identifying them and then adjusting your driving appropriately.

HAZARD PERCEPTION

Hazard perception is your ability to scan for potential risks on the road and to identify them before they become a problem. This skill is important for safe driving and helps prevent crashes. Hazard perception requires:

- Attentiveness.
- Quick decision-making.
- Ability to react appropriately to changing situations.

A hazard is anything that requires you to make a change. When you're behind the wheel, you should always be looking for hazards or responding to them.

A hazard might require you to change your speed or direction.

- A hazard can be an immediate danger, such as a child running out onto the road, or something less serious, such as a trash can in the road, coming up to a speed limit sign, or approaching the turn to your driveway.
- A hazard can be stationary or moving.
- There could be more than one hazard at the same time. It's your responsibility as a driver to determine which hazard requires the most urgent response.

Drive slower when approaching hazards to give yourself more space time to make safe decisions.

